

CONSCIOUSNESS AS PRESENCE

What results if we understand phenomenal consciousness not as a mysterious stuff but as the being or the presence of the world itself ? In other words, what results if we think of consciousness not as something present but as presence itself ?

Such presence would be *perspectival*. It would be, for instance, the presence of this or that side or aspect of an object in space. It would be the presence of a day-dream that depended on a local context that we might call a phenomenal stream. In other words, what we tend to think of as a consciousness stuff inhabiting a particular “material” organism would be world-from-point-of-view. This perspectival presence of the world is *like* the “interior” of a sentient organism. It is *like* a stream of “experience.”

Is this idealism ? I think it is closer to idealism than physicalism, at least until the transcendence of logic is emphasized (as it is in other papers and videos.) But once the transcendence of “logic” or “ideality” is appreciated, it becomes clear why it is THE world that is “streamed.” Language is immediately world-directed or “turned outward.” To deny this is a performative contradiction.

Ontocubism (a kind of unmitigated perspectivism) is not subjective idealism. While it does account for the “from-a-point-of-view-ness” of the world, surely a motivator for subjective idealism, it also accounts for our meeting in a single world in terms of direct access to “transcendent” objects. Such objects include

concepts. Indeed, the transcendence of concepts is presupposed in any attempt to communicate.

So the world is understood as a system of intentional objects that are “accessed” perspectively. So it can also be understood as a system of “torrents” or “streams.” Such torrents are constituted by situations that are themselves constituted by aspects of objects.